PTSD: National Center for PTSD

Impact of Event Scale - Revised (IES-R) for *DSM-IV*

Weiss, & Marmar, 1996

To Obtain Scale

Description

NOTE: This measure was based on *DSM-III* (IES) and *DSM-IV* (IES-R) criteria for PTSD. See a list of all measures, including those updated to *DSM-5*.

The IES-R is a 22-item self-report measure (for *DSM-IV*) that assesses subjective distress caused by traumatic events. It is a revised version of the older version, the 15-item IES (Horowitz, Wilner, & Alvarez, 1979). The IES-R contains 7 additional items related to the hyperarousal symptoms of PTSD, which were not included in the original IES. Items correspond directly to 14 of the 17 *DSM-IV* symptoms of PTSD. The IES-R has not been updated to match the *DSM-5*, so it does not include items to full assess negative alterations in cognition and mood, for instance. Respondents are asked to identify a specific stressful life event and then indicate how much they were distressed or bothered during the past seven days by each "difficulty" listed.

Scoring

Items are rated on a 5-point scale ranging from 0 ("*not at all*") to 4 ("*extremely*"). The IES-R yields a total score (ranging from 0 to 88) and subscale scores can also be calculated for the Intrusion, Avoidance, and Hyperarousal subscales. The authors recommend using means instead of raw sums for each of these subscales scores to allow comparison with scores from the Symptom Checklist 90 - Revised (SCL-90-R; Derogatis, 1994). In general, the IES-R (and IES) is not used to diagnosis PTSD.

Sample Item

"Any reminders brought back feelings about it." (Respondents rate their degree of distress during the past 7 days on a 5-point scale.)

Versions

The 15-item IES is the original scale but is missing *DSM-IV* hyperarousal symptoms (Horowitz, Wilner, & Alvarez, 1979).

References

Weiss, D. S., & Marmar, C. R. (1996). The Impact of Event Scale - Revised. In J. Wilson & T. M. Keane (Eds.), *Assessing psychological trauma and PTSD* (pp. 399-411). Guilford. (NOTE: Includes measure in its entirety.)

To Obtain Scale

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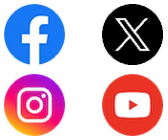
Measure availability: We provide information on a variety of measures assessing trauma and PTSD. These measures are intended for use by qualified mental health professionals and researchers. Measures authored by National Center staff are available as direct downloads or by request. Measures developed outside of the National Center can be requested via contact information available on the information page for the specific measure.

PTSD Information Voice Mail: (802) 296-6300
Email: **ncptsd@va.gov**
Also see: **VA Mental Health**



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